

Documentation Process Team Brainstorming & Outline

 **Background**

Problem Company Faced

- No central documentation repository even though the company had and was using SharePoint Classic.
- There were no policies regarding documentation.
- IT employees were creating and using multiple copies of documents and storing them on their laptops.
- Projects were giving duplicates or incorrect versions to multiple clients.
- Clients complained about incorrect deliverables.
- Clients complained about poorly structured, badly written, and unprofessional document deliverables.

Draft proposed to IT Leadership for **Documentation Process** from inception through drafting, revision, approval, and publication to the SharePoint repository, which was to house the Baseline Deliverable which would be the Single Source of Truth (SSOT).

Outcome

Portions of the process were approved for other governance content within the QMS — specifically the HITRUST Policies and Procedures document.

Draft Documentation Process Proposal

Content below consists of brainstorming and ideation for the draft to deliver to IT Leadership.

Document Control Components	
Title	Company Documentation Process
Unique ID	IT-QUL-PRO-0875
Owning Department / Area / Group	IT
Owner	CIO
Approval Chain	Librarian > VP of Quality > CIO

Review Timeframe	VP of Quality reviews annually on Approval Date. <i>Editor's note:</i> Confirm if 1 or 2 year review is appropriate.
Document History	All Governance content has a History table to note changes, by ID, and with a date time stamp.

 **Note:** Draft governance documentation is kept in the Working section of the repository with access limited to the Quality Team. Once approved by the Owner, a document is moved into the published content section of SharePoint that all of IT has access to.

Governance & Compliance Considerations

 **Editorial note:** Need to ensure that the appropriate audit artifacts are produced by the documentation process. This includes document controls such as unique ID, versioning, and history. Author needs to research specific governance concerns and ensure the content addresses them.

Document Control Governance

There is a solid basis for Documentation Control to be included in the Quality Management System (QMS).

Framework / Regulation	Documentation Control Requirements
Sarbanes-Oxley Act (SOX)	Requires documented internal controls, evidence retention, and controlled procedures supporting financial reporting. Documentation must be maintained and available for audit.
HIPAA	Security Rule (§164.316) requires policies and procedures to be

	documented, maintained, reviewed, updated, and retained for specified periods.
PCI DSS	Requires documented security policies, operational procedures, review cycles, and version-controlled documentation supporting cardholder data protection.
ISO 9001	Clause 7.5 ("Documented Information") explicitly requires control of creation, approval, revision, distribution, access, storage, and retention.
ISO/IEC 27001	Clause 7.5 requires control of documented information, including identification, review, approval, versioning, retention, and protection.
NIST SP 800-53	Multiple controls (e.g., PL, CM, PM families) require documented policies, procedures, review schedules, approvals, and maintenance.
SOC 2	Requires documented policies, procedures, evidence management, change control, and governance processes to demonstrate effective controls.
FDA 21 CFR Part 820	Requires controls over electronic records, audit trails, record retention, and change management of regulated documentation.

FDA 21 CFR Part 11	Requires controls over electronic records, audit trails, record retention, and change management of regulated documentation.
CMMC 2.0	Requires documented policies and procedures across security domains, with periodic review and maintenance.

Governance Controls

Requires controls such as:

- Document ownership
- Approval before release
- Version control
- Periodic review
- Change tracking
- Controlled distribution
- Retention and archival
- Prevention of unintended use of obsolete documents

Audit Artifacts

Across nearly all of these frameworks, auditors expect evidence that ensures the following:

Artifact	Demonstrates	Process	Metadata Tag
Documents (files, content)	have unique identifiers	Use Flow Automate to create Unique ID for document.	Doc ID
Documents	have owners	New document request record captures owner information	Owner

Documents	approved before publication	Research: Can Flow Automate & SharePoint do this?	Status Marker: Approved
Revisions	tracked	Research: Document Mgmt System, tool captures history? Manual entry in History table.	History captures: Changed by ID (& role) Changed Date / Time Change Description Research: • Ability to compare versions side by side? • Roll back to a previous version?
Reviews	occur on a defined schedule	Document record captures approval date. Record sets approval frequency (6 months, 1, 2, or 3 years)	Review Research: • Doc Mgmt System auto-schedules review date? • Back track two weeks to ensure it appears on Quality calendar?

Obsolete versions	are removed or archived	Research: Content Management system / Doc Mgmt System able to archive / deprecate?	Status: set to Archived
Access permissions	are controlled	Only Quality team has access to working content & files. All of IT can access Published content & files	Status: set to In Progress
Retention periods	are defined and followed	Document / Content record identifies document type and overarching governance area, which describes retention period.	Doc Type Governance Area Retention Period

Process Development



Editor's note: Use step-action table to capture steps showing role (who) does step (what) resulting in deliverable or status. Please note that no document management system has been selected yet. Try to keep content application agnostic. Need to flesh out requirements for the system and note ties to project management / Agile system.

Access Points

There needs to be multiple ways users can access documents within the process workflow. Access Points can include metadata elements (Author, Project, Client, Company, Doc Type, etc.)



Team Brainstorming Session

Potential document statuses to consider (ideas below brainstormed with Quality team:

Draft Stage (with modifier status)

New → Draft

Draft → Technical Review

Technical Review → Reconcile

Reconcile → Edit

Edit → Accept / Reject Changes

Accept / Reject Changes → Finalized

Finalized → Validation (Approve / Reject)

Validation approved → Published

Validation rejected → Returns to Draft status

Hold occurs if a project / initiative is stopped pending Leadership determination.

Reviewed

Updated (formerly published document needs modification--version number increment)

In Edit

Edited

Submit for Approval

Approved / Published / Final?

Rejected (or just back to Draft?)

Step-Action Table: Process for a New Document

Role (Who)	Step (Does What)	Result (Deliverable or Status)
Project Manager (PM) Product Manager Manager	Needs document / file / content.	Creates Request using form in self-help area of Quality site on intranet.
Project Manager (PM) Product Manager Manager	Accesses and completes Request form. Includes: 1. Internal or external document? a. If Project: i. Project Name ii. Client Name b. If internal: i. Internal Project Name OR ii. Initiative Name OR iii. Governance 2. Document Type (Tool, Best Practice, Project Document, Drawing — see Appendix A for complete list.)	Completed Form.

	3. Subject area, such as Network, Security, Architecture, Compliance, Source Control, etc. 4. Audience — client, technical, business, leadership, or all (internal to company)	
(Automation step) Automated System	Forwards completed Request form to Documentation Team.	New work request appears in Documentation Team inbox (monitored by Librarian).
Librarian	Updates Document Tracking System with new document record by importing the Request form.	System captures metadata from form: • Internal / External • Document Type • Project / Initiative Name • PM Name • Domain (Discipline / Subject)
Librarian	Saves record.	Record stored.
(Automated step) Automated System	Creates unique ID for document to insert into Record.	Unique ID Example: Department-Project-Doc Type-auto-generated four digit number (cross-reference table of departments, table of projects / initiatives / governance)

		IT-BRD-POL-#### Note: Each additional document created for a given IT project increments the four-digit number by one.
(Automated step) Automated System	Sets Version number and stage.	Version number is now zero (0) and Stage is set to Draft.
VP Quality VP Manager Librarian	Assigns new document request to writer (Author).	Record updated with Author metadata.
VP Quality VP Manager Librarian	Assigns Reviewer to the document. (Cross-reference table of domain SMEs.)	Record updated with Reviewer metadata.
(Automated step) Automated System	Forwards link to document Record to writer and CCs reviewer. Sample text: The Quality Team received a new document request [link] that has been assigned to Author [name] and Reviewer [name]. Access the link to create the document so that all the metadata is automatically included. The system will use the appropriate	Email sent to Author and Reviewer.

	template for the document type selected. Contact [Librarian name] with questions. Reviewer, you will receive a review task after writer completes the initial draft.	
Author	Creates draft from document Record within system.	Draft document created and saved to Quality Working repository.
Author	Works draft. (This includes research, questions to SMEs, PM, etc.)	Updated document draft.
Author	Submits draft for technical review.	System: Updates Status to In Review. Reviewer receives email with link to the document and instructional information.
Reviewer	Reviews document by adding notes, questions, comments, corrections.	Edited version saved within system.
Reviewer	When review complete, return document to Author to reconcile (accept / reject changes).	Author receives document back. Team Note: This is an iterative loop until all

		questions / comments have been addressed.
Author Reviewer	Iteratively works through all comments, questions, issues, modifications from Reviewer until all are closed.	Draft document passes the Technical Review Gate.
Author	Submits document to Editor for review (style, organization, grammar / spelling, components).	Record updated to In Edit .
Editor	Reviews document.	If rejected, status returns to Draft . If approved, status moves to Validation .
(If rejected) Author	Receives email with link to document containing Editor's notes, comments, questions, corrections, modifications.	Begins revision. Loops back to the appropriate review segment (either back to Editor or back to Technical Reviewer). Editor's note: This could be a small iterative loop between just Editor and Author, or it could be between Author & Technical Review & Editor depending on the comments.
(If approved) Editor	Moves document into Validation portion of process.	Librarian receives notification.

		Status set to Validation.
Librarian	Reviews document	Document either approved or rejected. If rejected, document goes back to initial draft step. May need team documentation meeting to determine what the actual document requirements are and what needs to be done to remediate.
If rejected: (Automated step) Automated System	Resets status to Draft and notifies Author.	Author receives link to document. Should also receive meeting invite to discuss with Editor, Librarian, and Document Owner (or proxy).
If approved (Automated step) Automated System	Forwards notification with link to document to Document Owner	Status remains Validation.
Owner	Reviews document. May make notes , comments, add questions, provide suggestions. Adding any markup is an automatic rejection.	Document either approved or rejected. If rejected document goes back to initial draft step. Team documentation meeting mandatory to determine what the actual document requirements are and

		what needs to be done to remediate. If approved, document status set to Approved.
If rejected: (Automated step) Automated System	Sets status to Draft.	Sends notification to Author. CCs Editor, Librarian, PM, and Owner.
If rejected: Editor	Sets up meeting between stakeholders: Author, Editor, Librarian, PM, and Owner.	Review requirements details to outline plan for document adjustments.
If approved: Librarian	Publishes document to repository	All tasks marked closed.

Step-Action Table: Process for Updating an Existing Document

Published documents may occasionally require updates. Examples for appropriate updates may include technology change, scope creep, data flow modifications, and so on.

Role (Who)	Step (Does What)	Result (Deliverable or Status)
Project Manager (PM) Product Manager Manager	Needs update to an existing document	Creates Request using form in self-help area of Quality site on intranet.
(Automated step) Automated System	Flags document record file with the status Update.	Document / Content no longer available to all IT in the repository as Document has been moved to Quality's Working repository.

PM	Creates meeting invite (and agenda) with Author, Editor, Librarian. CCs Owner. Include: • Name of Document • Summary of changes needed (technology changed, incorrect steps in section (Name), etc.) • Determination of whether this is a minor change or a major change. Quality: Define minor and major change.	Meeting invites with link to document sent to attendees.
Librarian	Assigns task to Author	Author receives notification with link to document. Document task includes information from meeting.
Author	Makes updates to document.	Automatic notifications sent to document stakeholders.
Author	Submits document for technical review.	Reviewer receives notification with link to document.
All	Repeat the iterative Review process until there are no more comments or changes.	Editor receives notification with status set to Validate .

Editor	Reviews document.	Either approves or rejects updates to document. Repeat iterative loop with Author until approval status can be determined.
Editor	Sets status to Approved	Owner receives notification with link to document.
Owner	Reviews document.	Either approves or rejects updates to document. Repeat iterative loop with Author, Editor, Librarian, and Owner until approval status can be determined.
Owner	approves document	Sets status to Approved.
(Automated step) System	Increments version number appropriately based on type of change.	System notifies all stakeholders that status is Published and document is in the IT documentation repository.